

Write a guided analysis of the following text.

1. The following extract is from the play *Things I Know To Be True* by Andrew Bovell. Bob has just learned that his wife has secretly been saving money.

FRAN. It was mine. My wage. I earned it.

BOB. Right. It's just that every pay packet I ever earned went straight into a bank account with both our names on it. There was never a mine. Just ours.

FRAN. It was my 'Get Out' money, Bob. I saw it happen to my mother. Stuck in a miserable marriage with a man she didn't love because she couldn't afford to leave. It wasn't going to happen to me. So, I put a little away. Every pay. Until I had enough to buy some shares.

BOB. Shares!

FRAN. Mining. Iron ore. The price goes through the roof and suddenly I'm a wealthy woman. I start to get nervous. I read the papers. I can see what's coming so I sell. And then the price goes down. I played it well.

BOB. Right.

FRAN. I'm not justifying it... I don't have to.

BOB. No. But a man wouldn't mind an explanation why he wasn't let in on it.

FRAN. I told you... I had to know I could go if I ever needed to.

BOB. Did you... Ever need to?

*Her silence is the answer.*

What stopped you?

FRAN. The children. I stayed because of the kids.

BOB. And me? Where was I in this picture?

FRAN. You can't love someone for thirty years straight. You fall out of love. Or there's no time for love. Or love is not the point. Getting by is the point. Raising children is the point. I'll stop if you don't want to hear this.

BOB. No... I want to know.

FRAN. You fall out of love. You just do. And you think about, maybe, something else. Another life. But it passes. If you wait long enough, one day you realise that the man you did love is still there, still sitting across the table from you, still sleeping on the other side of the bed. And you settle for that.

BOB. You settled for me.

FRAN. I'm being honest, Bob.



- How is dialogue used to communicate the emotional tension in the relationship between Fran and Bob?

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